

IANS

FLAGGED PM Modi, Nitin Nabin and Amit Shah at an NDA parliamentary party 'Mangal Milan' meeting, Aug. 11

Two days before the Sangh Parivar assembled at Gudilova in Visakhapatnam district, the Bharatiya Janata Party started its organisational overhaul. The Akhil Bharatiya Samanvay Baithak, which ran from August 19 to 21, brought together 32 Sangh organisations to compare notes on issues of national import. Nitin Nabin attended it for the first time as BJP president. A question awaiting him there: what was he doing to strengthen the party's network?

His answer had already arrived on August 17, and its clearest feature was what it left out. There is no television face in the senior ranks, no celebrity import. Amit Malviya, who ran the party's IT and social media operation for 11 years, is gone. Tejasvi Surya, its most marketable young leader, is out of the Yuva Morcha. Sambit Patra, a familiar face on prime time, is now also Northeast coordinator.

What Nabin has instead is a 64-member team, many of them new, the bulk of them drawn from state units rather than Parliament's front benches. The party has seen a testing phase in the past few months and has responded to it by promoting people who understand how the organisation is built rather than people who can explain it on air. That said, some familiar faces have found favour again after time in the political wilderness—Ram Madhav, a member of the RSS national executive who was dropped in 2020 (reportedly due to differences with Union home minister Amit Shah), is back as national vice-president while former Union minister Smriti Irani, who lost in Amethi in 2024, is a newly minted national general secretary.

NABIN'S PREDECESSORS HAD PUT NEWISH TEAMS IN PLACE AFTER THEY TOOK OVER, BUT THE 2026 REVAMP CUTS MUCH DEEPER

Nabin's predecessors had put newish teams in place after they took over, but the 2026 revamp cuts much deeper. Of the eight general secretaries under former party president J.P. Nadda, only two, Vinod Tawde and Sunil Bansal, survive. Nine of the 13 vice-presidents are new, as are 15 of the 16 secretaries, and all seven morcha chiefs. Meanwhile, another durable performer, Tarun Chugh, has been made central office in-charge, the position Arun Singh held before him. The latter has been handed the party's prize state, Gujarat. Tawde takes on Uttar Pradesh, Satish Poonia takes up the vacancy in Punjab, which has had no state in-charge since former Gujarat CM Vijay Rupani died in the Ahmedabad plane crash in June 2025. The churn, it seems, runs in a specific direction. The posts filled with new names are the ones that face the electorate. The posts reinforced are the ones that build the cadre.

LEARNING THE LESSONS

The BJP won 240 Lok Sabha seats in 2024 and lost its majority. It drew three lessons from its diminution, and all three are evident in this list. The first concerns mending ties with the Sangh. What broke in May 2024, at the height of the LS campaign when Nadda told an interviewer the party was self-sufficient and no longer needed the RSS, has largely been repaired, but the Sangh is not fully on board. The state assembly campaigns since, the organisational overhaul, they all show that the Sangh outfits are being consulted and taken onboard in most of the decision-making. Yet, gaps still exist. The BJP leadership is